

Duo Passport

Reducing login friction.

ROLE

Lead Designer

TEAM

Product Manager · Engineering · Co-designer

TIMELINE

2024

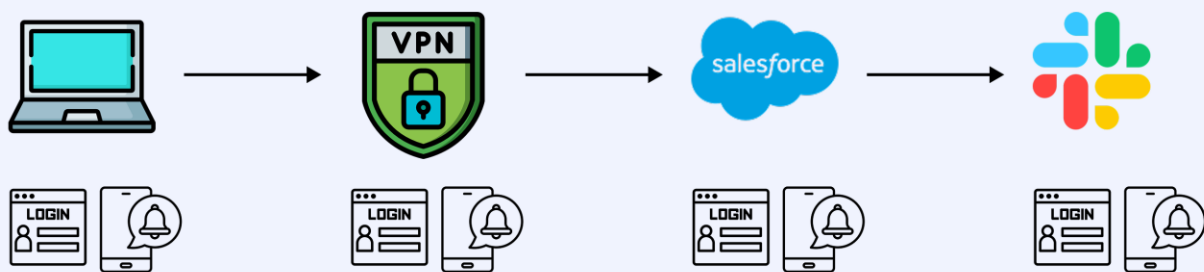
STATUS

Shipped May 2024 · 100+ customers adopted · 3,000+ users experiencing up to 66% fewer authentications

— OVERVIEW

Reduce login fatigue.

Imagine a user attempting to log in to an application using their corporate laptop. First, they need to enter their username and password for their laptop, then authenticate using two-factor authentication (2FA). Next, they must log into their VPN with another set of credentials. Finally, they log into the application itself, requiring yet another username, password, and 2FA entry. Passport's goal is to reduce login fatigue. The user logs in once to their machine and has unlimited access to all of their applications. My task was to create a configuration page that would assist IT administrators in setting up Passport.



All icons created by Smashicons - Flaticon

— PROCESS

Original design

The original idea was to add another checkbox under SSO → settings. Simple in theory, but it quickly became clear that Passport combined five distinct Duo features and couldn't be reduced to a single toggle.

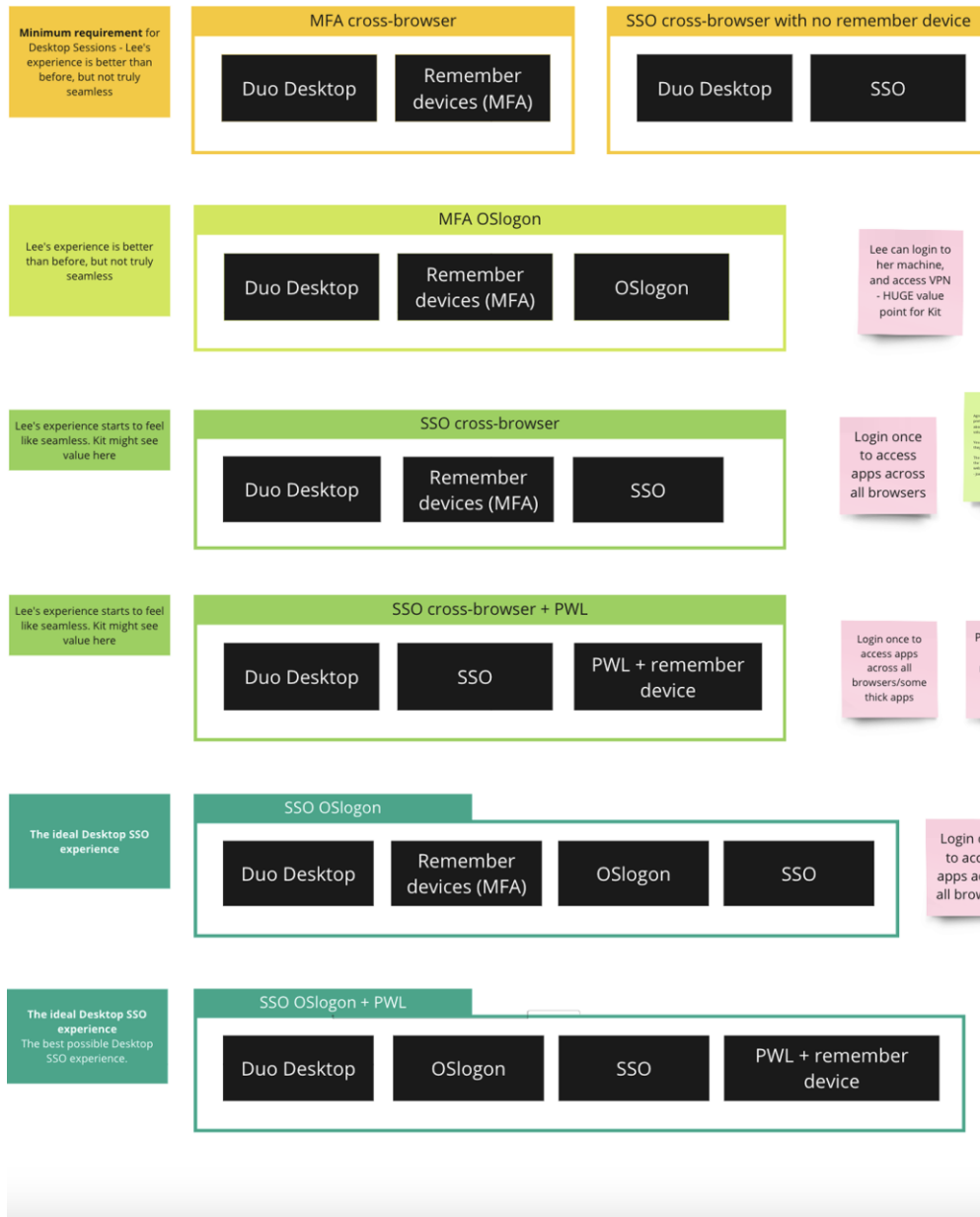
The screenshot displays a settings interface for Duo Single Sign-On (SSO). It includes the following sections:

- Proactive password change:** A section with two radio button options. The first option, "Don't allow users to proactively change their password", is selected. Below it, a note states: "Users will have to wait until their password has expired to change it." The second option, "Allow users to proactively change their password", is unselected. Below it, a note states: "Users will be given the option to change their password via the login prompt." Below these are two lock icons with associated requirements: "A transport type of LDAPS or STARTTLS is required to allow users to proactively change their password" and "Each authentication proxy must be version 5.5 or later to allow users to proactively change their password".
- Session Duration:** A section with a text input field containing the number "8" and the label "hours". Below the input field, a note states: "The number of hours a user will stay logged into Duo Single Sign-On before having to authenticate with their primary credential again. Must specify between 1-24 hours."
- Desktop SSO:** A section with a checked checkbox and the label "Enable shared sessions for SSO".
- Logout Redirect URL:** A section with a text input field and the label "optional". Below the input field, a note states: "URL users will be redirected to after logging out of Duo Single Sign-On."

Original concept · Passport as a single checkbox under SSO settings

When does the IT admin start to see value in Passport?

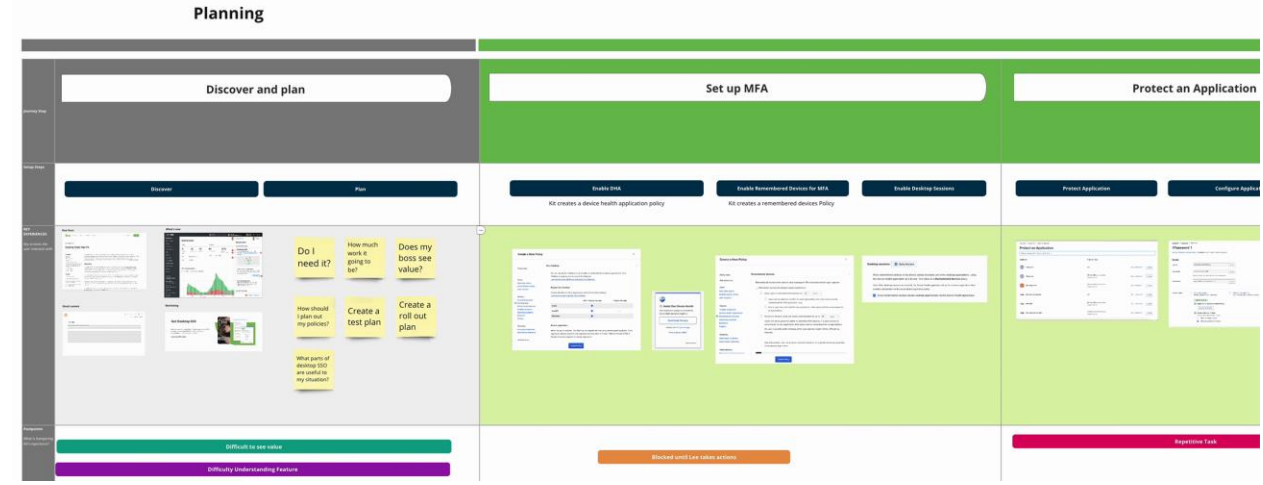
Passport is a combination of many Duo features. How many of these features need to be configured by IT admins for their employees to truly login just once? I mapped the feature combinations: Desktop Sessions, MFA OSlogon, SSO cross-browser, and SSO OSlogon, to understand the minimum configuration that would deliver meaningful value.



Feature combination mapping · minimum configuration for value delivery

It's not just another checkbox

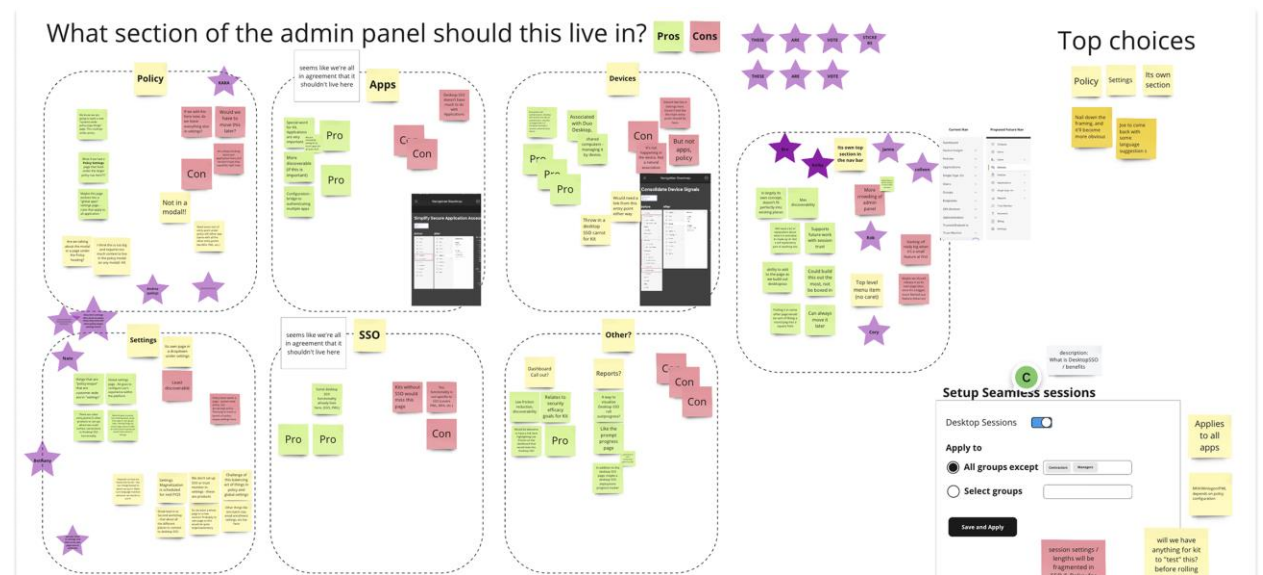
Setting up Passport is not just another checkbox for the user. I mapped out all the steps a new customer has to complete to get to the "login once" state: from Discover and Plan, through Set up MFA, to Protect an Application. This journey map revealed friction points that a simple settings toggle would never surface.



Journey map · end-to-end admin setup flow for the "login once" state

Location

One of the toughest decisions was determining where this feature should live. Since it combined five Duo features, Passport seemed relevant to multiple areas of the admin panel. We conducted a workshop to evaluate the pros and cons of each possible section: Policy, Settings, Apps, SSO, Devices, and ultimately decided to create a new section under Policy.



Location workshop · evaluating placement across Policy, Settings, Apps, SSO, and Devices

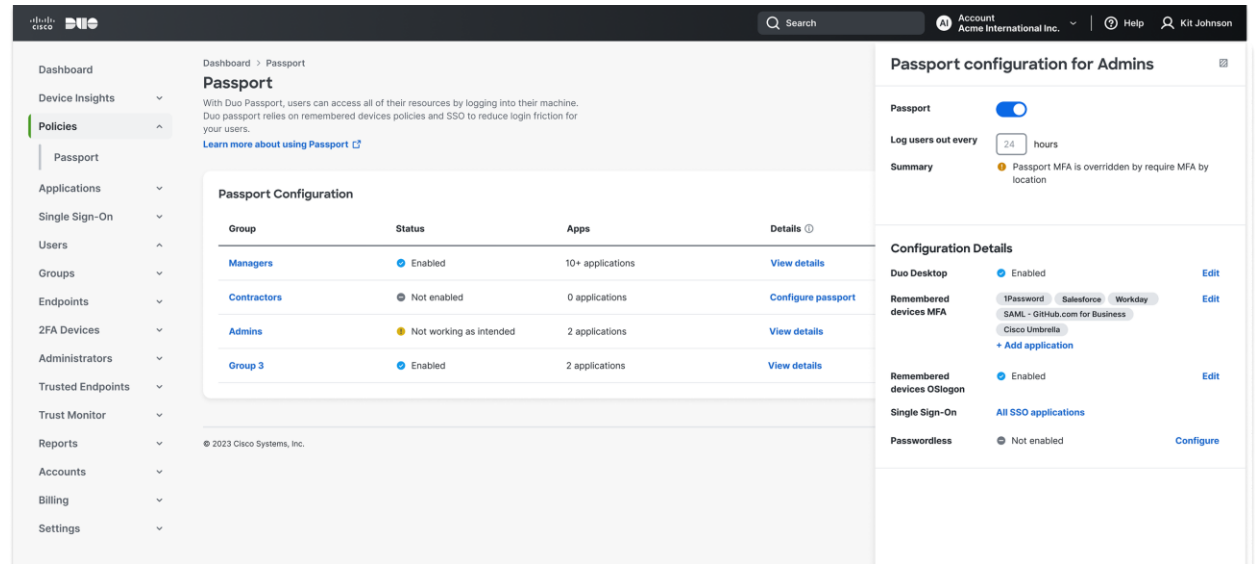
— DESIGN EVOLUTION

Exploring the right approach.

EXPLORATION 01

Focus on troubleshooting

This design aimed to help users understand the state of their Passport configuration and assist with troubleshooting. It surfaced per-group status: enabled, not enabled, not working as intended, so admins could diagnose issues without digging through separate settings pages.



Exploration 01 · per-group status surface for admin troubleshooting

EXPLORATION 02

Setup wizard

One suggestion was to break the setup journey into steps and hand-hold the user through the process. While promising, this exploration felt out of scope for an MVP, as the complexity of branching paths and prerequisite validation made it a candidate for a future phase.

Set up Passport

✓

✓

3

4

Choose groupsEnable Duo DesktopConfigure experienceComplete requirements

Configure your custom Passport experience

The complete, seamless Passport experience includes 4 “Free Passes.” You can choose to set up any number of Free Passes, or all at once. Select which Free Passes you would like to configure and we will walk you through the setup steps.

In order to activate Passport in each case, the user must first log in with 2FA and lorem ipsum whatever else.

☐ OS Logon

While Passport is active, the user can log into their Windows device without 2FA.

[Learn more](#)

☒ MFA

While Passport is active, the user can log into any application on **the same web browser** without 2FA.

[Learn more](#)

☒ SSO

While Passport is active, the user can log into any application on **any web browser** without 2FA.

[Learn more](#)

☐ PWL

While Passport is active, the user can log into any application on any web browser **without a password**.

[Learn more](#)

[Cancel](#)

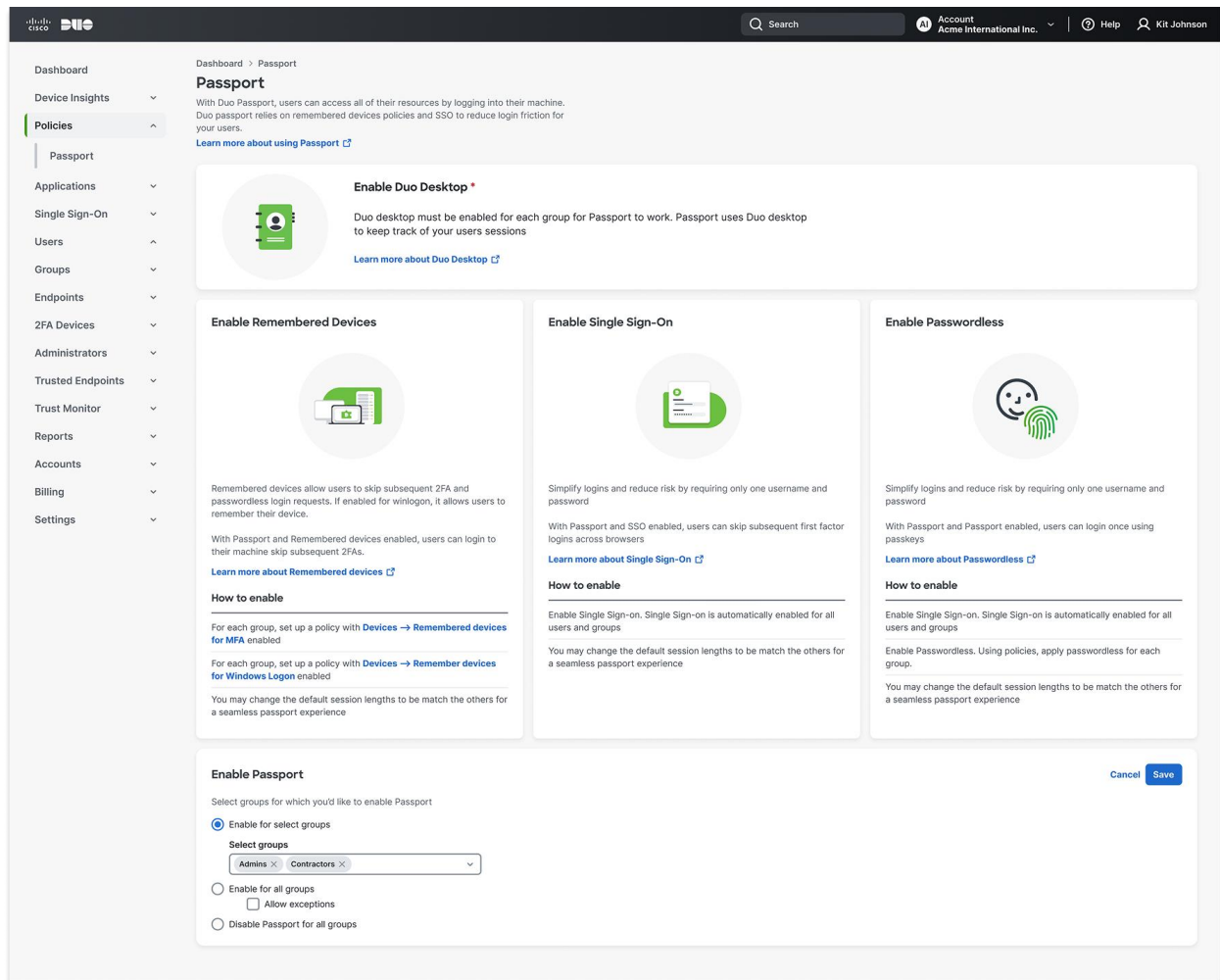
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Exploration 02 · stepped modal guiding admins through setup

EXPLORATION 03

Splash page

We wanted to promote Passport and draw attention to its page, so we explored various landing page designs. However, we decided against it, as a two-page flow seemed excessive for the initial configuration task.

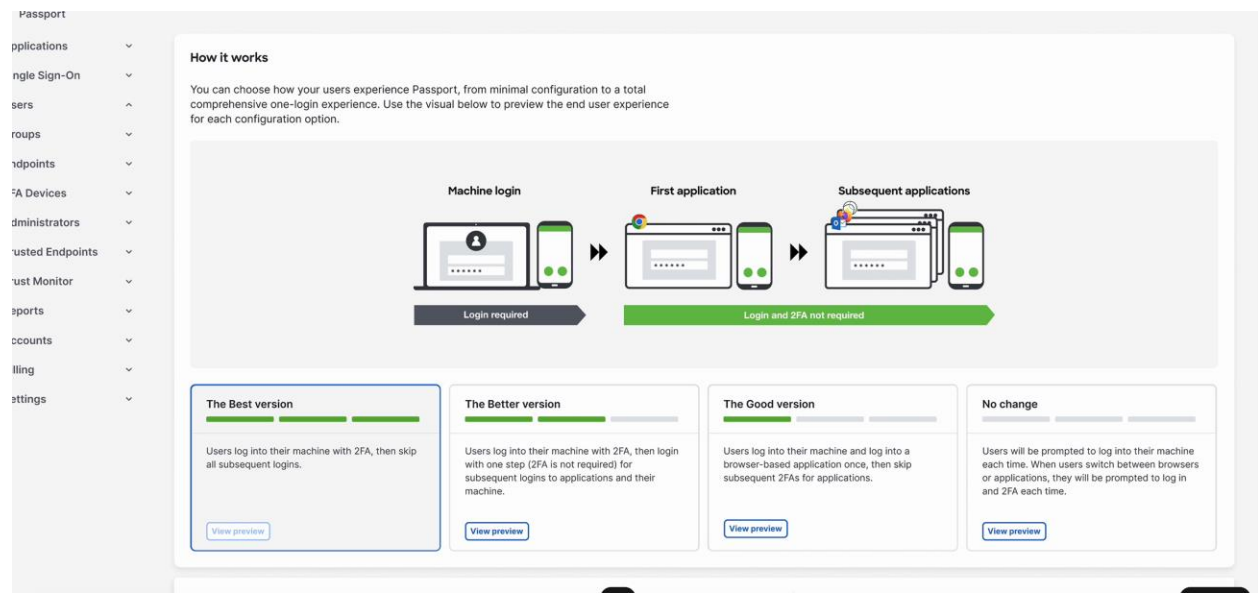


Exploration 03 · splash page promoting Passport as a featured entry point

EXPLORATION 04

Promote SSO and other Duo features

One major goal was to use Passport to encourage users to adopt SSO, OSLogon, and other Duo features. By providing recommendations, this design gives IT admins a preview of what their employees would experience. While promoting SSO was a key objective, we found that another feature, Passwordless, was negatively impacted by being linked to SSO. Since SSO adoption can be costly, we didn't want that to deter customers from using Passport.

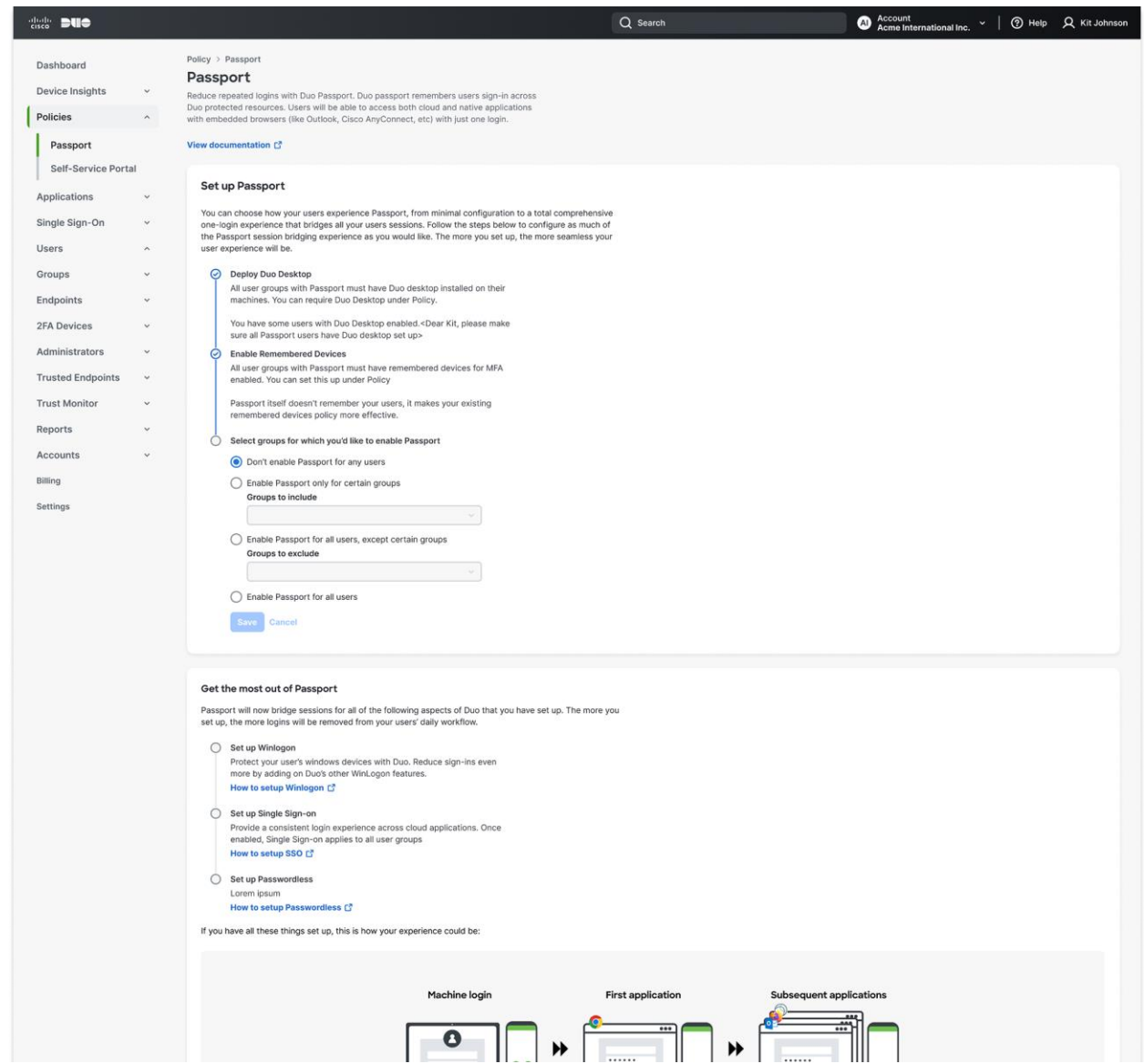


Exploration 04 · surfacing SSO and Duo feature recommendations inline

EXPLORATION 05

Checklist

The idea was to provide IT admins with a checklist to help them track their progress and identify which version of Passport they are using. However, we discovered that some steps couldn't be verified due to technical constraints. To avoid offering an inconsistent experience where only some tasks could be checked off, we decided to scrap this idea.



Exploration 05 · progress checklist for tracking setup completion

— RESEARCH

Design validation

We tested the cards design with 5 IT admins. The overall feedback was that the visuals helped build context. There were smaller things that needed tweaking. *I really like the way it's laid out, it makes it very easy. I could hand this to the vast majority of my IT staff and they would understand exactly what it is doing.*

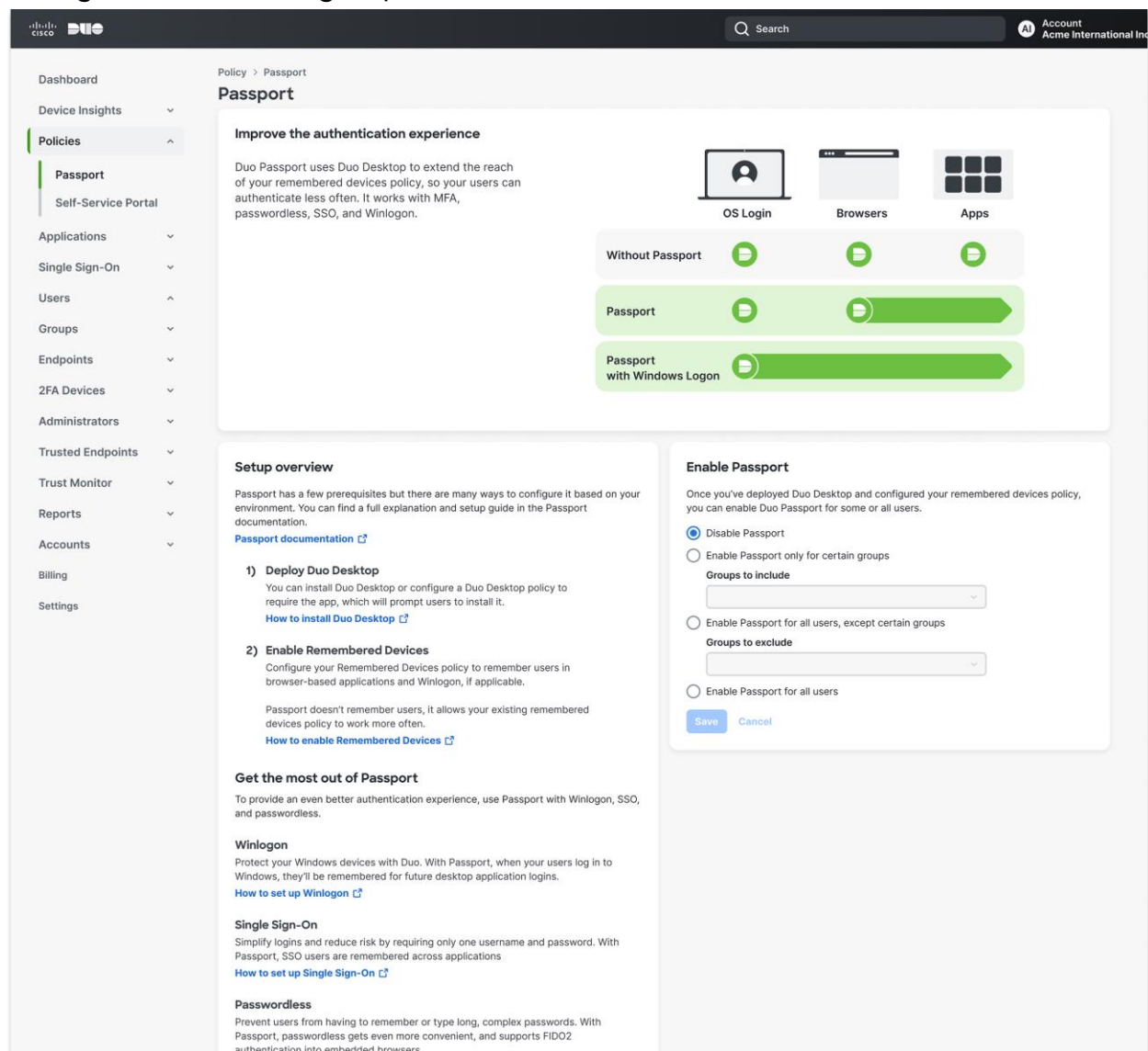
— IT Admin, design validation session

It's unclear to see where remember me kicks in and what the user experience is like and which applications this actually impacts.

- IT Admin, design validation session
- FINAL DESIGNS

The MVP

Based on our findings that SSO could be a potential adoption blocker and the technical constraints preventing checklists, we decided to keep the MVP straightforward. The design featured a simple set of instructions and a configuration area for groups.



Final MVP · simplified setup with group configuration and clear instructions

- IMPACT

Impact

We've already seen over 100 customers adopt the product since its release in May 2024. Over 3,000+ users are now experiencing a streamlined login experience where authentications have been reduced for them by as much as 66%.

Thank you for doing all the things to get Passport to the point we're at today, Sangeetha. Since the very beginning of this project you've been such an incredible facilitator, planner, and designer. You helped kick off the project and better identify requirements, led workshops to align the team on the vision, and iterated over SO many different UI directions until we found the one that struck the right balance amongst all the stakeholders. There was a ton of "invisible" work on this project too that you led with poise and dedication, including the new demo that you helped create at the 11th hour which is going to be such an important artifact for pitching this new product.

Congratulations on getting to the finish line, and I can't wait to see how everything goes with Passport in the wild!

— Manager

Sangeetha has been an amazing design partner to work with. She has been incredibly communicative, which has been a godsend with how behind I tend to get and with how many people are involved in these decisions. Sangeetha has been mindful of all of them, which requires a deep understanding of their needs: how this affects the longer-term goals of the policy team; what customers are trying to achieve, and what education they require to get there; what functionality is possible, plausible, and ideal from an engineering standpoint. She's one of those people who can take a problem and solve it to completion. If Sangeetha's got it, it will be completed to 100%, and it will be done thoroughly. My checklist just looks like "ask Sangeetha about X" and, importantly, it doesn't include "follow up with Sangeetha about X" — and holding that opinion of someone is among the highest professional praise I know how to give.

— Product Manager

